

ML Howell

Product Designer, San Francisco, CA



Contact

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Projects

Doodles, web app using gen AI

Postly, digital postcard app

Street Cleaning Parking, iOS app with 150 paid users, featured in ABC News and SF Standard

Tools

Figma

Claude

Adobe Suite

Paper

Midjourney

Reve

Skills

Interaction design

Prototyping

Design systems

User research

Typography

Web design

Light front-end (HTML/CSS)

Brand identity

Superpowers

Works fast

High craft

Always learning

Experience

JUN 2024 – MAR 2026

Guac (YC 2023), Founding Product Designer

Designed AI-powered tools for grocery stores. Shipped products to three multi-store grocery chains (21 stores live, 60-store chain onboarding).

Led design of iOS, Android, and web products spanning store ordering, forecasting and product recommendations, production planning, product assortment, and recipe management.

Led brand design, including conference booths, sales decks, printed materials, and website.

Managed contractors and external partners, including the developer who built the marketing site and vendors building conference booths, reviewing work, owning budgets and timelines, and ensuring high craft output.

Translated complex ML concepts into clear visual storytelling in the form of diagrams, decks, and animations.

NOV 2022 – MAY 2024

Afresh, Product Designer

Owned the design system through a full redesign, raising craft, improving product consistency, and accelerating team speed.

Led design of user onboarding, including the main UX flow, in-store training assets, and training platform.

Partnered with PMs and engineers across multiple product squads to conduct user research through store visits. Traveled to a key LA customer post-launch to diagnose adoption issues, observing across multiple days, and bringing findings back to PM and engineering.

NOV 2021 – NOV 2022

Afresh, Senior Brand Designer

Led design of a brand refresh, partnering with agency and 3D artists to elevate the brand. Extended the work across marketing, sales, social media, and events.

Led brand design of materials like conference booths, video, sales decks, annual reports, and microsites.

FEB 2019 – NOV 2021

theSkimm, Brand Designer

Designed interactive websites and branded materials.

Redesigned brand illustration identity for a company brand refresh, developing templates and usage guidelines.